

Long multiplication

Don't you touch that calculator!



Multiplying a large number by a single-digit number

This isn't as hard as it looks, but you will need to know your times tables up to 10×10 pretty well before you try this.

Write the large number
above the small one.

$$\begin{array}{r} \text{HTU} \\ 786 \\ \times 2 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

Multiply the single-digit number on the bottom by the units, then tens, then hundreds of the number at the top.

$$\begin{array}{r} 786 \\ \times 2 \\ \hline 12 \end{array} \rightarrow 6 \times 2 = 12$$

$$\begin{array}{r} 786 \\ \times 2 \\ \hline 12 \\ 160 \end{array} \rightarrow 80 \times 2 = 160$$

$$\begin{array}{r} 786 \\ \times 2 \\ \hline 12 \\ 160 \\ 1400 \end{array} \rightarrow 700 \times 2 = 1,400$$

$$\begin{array}{r} 12 \\ 160 \\ + 1400 \\ \hline 1572 \end{array} \quad \text{Finally, add up the answers to those three multiplications.}$$

So: $786 \times 2 = 1,572$

Now let's try the fast way

A quicker way of doing this is to write the answer to each multiplication on the same line, going from right to left. If you get an answer of ten or more when you're multiplying the units, tens, or hundreds, you "carry" the first digit of that answer, adding it to the column to the left.

$$\begin{array}{r} 285 \\ \times 3 \\ \hline 5 \\ 1 \end{array} \quad \begin{array}{l} 5 \times 3 = 15 \\ \text{Carry 1 to tens column.} \end{array}$$

$$\begin{array}{r} 285 \\ \times 3 \\ \hline 55 \\ 21 \end{array} \quad \begin{array}{l} 8 \times 3 = 24 \\ 24 + 1 = 25 \\ \text{Carry 2 to hundreds column.} \end{array}$$

$$\begin{array}{r} 285 \\ \times 3 \\ \hline 855 \\ 21 \end{array} \quad \begin{array}{l} 2 \times 3 = 6 \\ 6 + 2 = 8 \end{array}$$

Now have a go

$$\begin{array}{r} 385 \\ \times 2 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

$$\begin{array}{r} 723 \\ \times 4 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

$$\begin{array}{r} 210 \\ \times 3 \\ \hline \end{array}$$

$$\begin{array}{r} 974 \\ \times 8 \\ \hline \end{array}$$